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SIMILARITY REDUCTION CHECKLIST

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Similarity Reduction Checklist

Checklist | PDF-ready DOCX

A safe rewriting and citation hygiene checklist designed to reduce avoidable similarity problems before submission.

How to use this sample: Edit the highlighted placeholders, adapt the tone to your journal, and verify every factual statement before submission.

Before you start

- Do not aim only to reduce the percentage. Aim to improve originality, clarity, and source attribution.
- Never paraphrase technical content in a way that changes scientific meaning.
- Keep track of every source you consult while rewriting.

Section-wise checklist

Area	What to check	Done
Title and abstract	Remove copied phrases from prior drafts, old submissions, or published sources unless essential and properly cited.	☐
Introduction	Paraphrase concept summaries genuinely and cite the original studies that support them.	☐
Methods	Use standard terminology where necessary, but rewrite descriptive sentences in your own manuscript voice.	☐
Results	Avoid repeating long text from tables, figures, or earlier conference abstracts.	☐
Discussion	Distinguish clearly between your interpretation and prior literature; cite all borrowed ideas.	☐
References	Ensure every in-text citation appears in the reference list and vice versa.	☐
Figures/tables	Check captions and labels for copied wording from previous publications or templates.	☐
Self-overlap	Review whether thesis text, preprints, conference papers, or earlier articles need disclosure or careful rewriting.	☐

Common mistakes to avoid

- Replacing a few words while keeping the original sentence structure unchanged.
- Keeping copied review-style background paragraphs without primary citations.
- Forgetting to cite tables, adapted figures, borrowed definitions, or reused framework descriptions.
- Treating software-generated similarity percentages as the only measure of originality.

Final verification note

Final internal check completed by: [Name]

Areas revised most heavily: [Abstract / Introduction / Methods / Discussion / References]

THANK YOU

SIMILARITY REDUCTION SUPPORT

We help researchers improve
paraphrasing quality • citation accuracy • section-wise rewriting • self-overlap
control • submission safety

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sections and get a
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